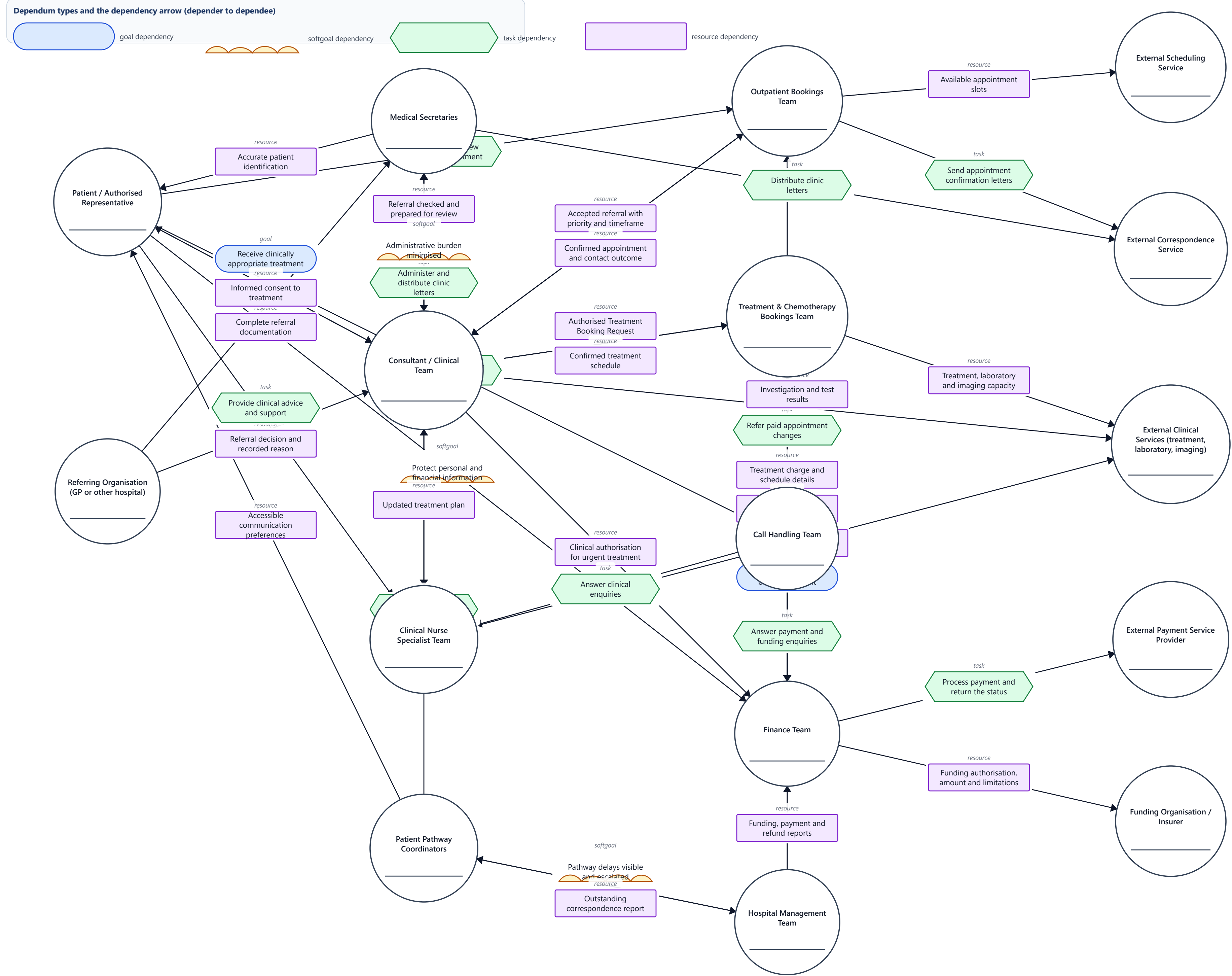




Assumptions, modelling choices and limitations - i* Strategic Dependency model

PURPOSE AND POSITION IN THE PROJECT

The SD and SR models were developed in Sprints 3 and 4, AFTER the initial release had been built. They did not inform the original design. They are used here as the evaluation lens for the alignment evaluation, and they are kept consistent with each other: the SR is the same model with four actors opened up, not a different model of the domain.

NOTATION

An arrow runs from the dependor to the dependee with the typed dependum in the middle. goal = a state of affairs the dependee must bring about; softgoal = a quality to be satisfied, judged rather than verified; task = an activity the dependee performs; resource = an entity the dependee produces or supplies. The horizontal bar under an actor name marks a position or role rather than a physical agent.

WHY RESOURCE DEPENDENCIES DOMINATE

The hospital depends on the external scheduling service for available appointment slots and on the funding organisation for an authorisation with an approved amount and its limitations. Both are RESOURCE dependencies: the hospital needs the thing, not the activity, and cannot produce it internally. This is the socio-technical insight that the process models alone conceal, and it is the root of several case-study failure modes.

ASSUMPTIONS AND LIMITATIONS

(1) The Clinical Nurse Specialist Administrative Support Team is subsumed into the Clinical Nurse Specialist Team because the case study attributes no distinct goal, task or resource to it. (2) The HPAS is not modelled as an actor: it is a system, not an agent, and has no goals of its own. (3) External services appear as dependees only, because the case study does not describe their internal behaviour. (4) Urgency is modelled as a soft goal rather than a goal, because the hospital has not agreed a complete set of urgency rules. (5) The model does not quantify dependency strength or failure probability, so it identifies risks but does not rank them.